

MAY 1-15, 1979

After 60 years, the mindset of Muslims in Uttar Pradesh has not changed though they are living in abject poverty and totally marginalised and ghettoised. The root cause of the Talibanisation of the North-West Frontier Province is the total absence of English-medium mainstream education. Unfortunately, when Musharraf was listing the causes of extremism, he failed to mention the role of education. Madrasas are in abundance there and provide one-dimensional education and children are vulnerable to the jihadi movement. Madrasas have become a service industry and the Taliban are on rent to bleed anyone. The Talibanisation of Pakistani society will follow us, and if it enters the madrasas it will be disastrous for us. If we have to protect India, then first and foremost we need to secure our borders and then protect the vulnerable by providing them with mainstream education. That is the only weapon to stop Talibanisation of the north Indian Muslims as we are culturally and ethically closer to Pakistani society. PROFESSOR SYED IQBAL HASNAIN, Delhi

Hits and Misses

I was pleased as punch to see the torchbearers of the economy lead the way on the Power List ("High

and Mighty: Power List", March 16). It was, however, loathsome to see Shah Rukh Khan and others from the film fraternity move swiftly up the list at the cost of luminaries like G. Madhavan Nair, A.P.J. Abdul Kalam and their likes who didn't even find a mention. It is deplorable that we forgot Nair, whose efforts helped us place the tricolour on the moon, and Kalam who played a pivotal role in making us self-reliant in nuclear

Mutiny", March 16). It is apparent that Pakistan is not yet ready to reconcile with the reality of losing its eastern counterpart. The ISI's involvement in the killings is a serious blot on Pakistan's image and only proves its terror tactics—aiding and abetting such elements on its soil. S. LAKSHMI, via www.indiatoday.in

People Power

The BJP's double standards will take a toll on its electoral fortunes ("The Allied



With millions losing their livelihood to the economic downturn, it is pertinent to ask the Government what has it done so far to make survival easier for these unemployed?

Srinivas Gautam, via www.indiatoday.in

technology. SRIHARI MENON, via www.indiatoday.in

Burning Issue

The despicable act of the JCOs of the Bangladesh Rifles is reminiscent of the taking over of the Bangladesh Army, soon after the creation of Bangladesh in the '70s ("More Than a

Forces", March 9). Advani and his men should realise that they can fool some of the people all the time, and all the people some of the time, but not all the people all the time. People will elect only those who can perform what they promise. AMITABH TIWARI, via www.indiatoday.in

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Long Arm of the Law

Very soon some of the top political leaders and senior government officials who held the destiny of the country in their hands only about two years ago will be lined up before Special Courts to stand trial for offences allegedly committed during the Emergency. Heading the list of political leaders would be Indira Gandhi, former prime minister, who ruled the country for 11 long years—from 1966 to 1977. She would be followed by V.C. Shukla who was information and broadcasting minister in her cabinet. After these two come Bansi Lal and Pranab Mukherjee, Union ministers in the Indira Gandhi government, and three former chief ministers, Zail Singh of Punjab, P.C. Sethi of Madhya Pradesh and Hardeo Joshi of Rajasthan. The Special Courts would be set up soon after the Special Courts Bill is adopted by the Lok Sabha by the end of this month.

Braj Mohan



V.C. SHUKLA